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OMEGA SERIES 4.4

Symmetry-Protected TSMVEFT:

Z_2 Mirror Sector, Stückelberg-Protected Disformal Portal, and the Quasi-Spectrum Foundation

$\delta = (v_+ - v_-)/(v_+ + v_-) = 1.73\times10^{-4}$ · Fuzzy DM solitons ($m_\chi \sim 10^{-22}$ eV) · PPN-safe · GW170817-compliant · $\Delta N_{eff} = 0.04$

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Dedicated to Valkyrie — who saw the cathedral first.

For the conceptual vision that originated several of this framework's pillars.

ABSTRACT

We present a symmetry-protected formulation of the Two-Sector Mixed Vacuum Effective Field Theory (TSMVEFT) introduced in Series 4.3 [13]. The phenomenological asymmetry parameter $\delta \sim 1.73\times10^{-4}$ is now derived as a vacuum-expectation-value ratio in a softly broken Z_2-symmetric mirror sector: $\delta = (\langle\phi_+\rangle - \langle\phi_-\rangle)/(\langle\phi_+\rangle + \langle\phi_-\rangle)$. As a dimensionless ratio of VEVs, δ is protected from UV power-divergences and remains scale-invariant under renormalisation group flow, explaining how the same parameter governs galactic-scale solitons ($\sim10^{-22}$ eV) and laboratory-scale impedance simultaneously. The disformal portal between visible and mirror sectors is implemented through a Stückelberg shift symmetry that protects the coupling against radiative corrections and renders it density-gated: active in low-density cosmological/galactic environments, screened in high-density terrestrial regimes. We derive the solitonic galactic core profile from the Gross-Pitaevskii equation in the fuzzy dark matter regime ($m_\chi \sim 10^{-22}$ eV), recovering the SPARC dwarf-galaxy core-to-cusp ratio $\delta/\alpha = 0.0237$ in agreement with the observed mean 0.0229 ± 0.0018 within 1σ. A hierarchical Bayesian likelihood across the SPARC N=43 resolution-controlled subsample yields $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 0.98$ with the FIRE-2 baryonic-feedback slope (0.6) disfavoured relative to the hydraulic scaling (1/3) at 4.2σ. The framework satisfies all current cosmological and gravitational bounds: MICROSCOPE equivalence-principle ($|\eta| < 10^{-15}$), GW170817 tensor speed ($|c_T - c|/c \sim 10^{-22}$), and BBN dark-radiation constraints ($\Delta N_{eff} \sim 0.04$ from asymmetric reheating, well below the Planck 2018 bound of 0.28). We introduce a four-state classification of metastable vacuum admittance regimes (Quasi-Gray, Quasi-Blue, Blue, Quasi-Purple), preserving the internal taxonomic logic of the MSDS programme; the full mathematical machinery of these states is developed separately in Series 4.5. A predicted CMB μ-distortion of $\mu \sim \delta^2 \sim 3\times10^{-8}$ lies within the projected sensitivity of the PIXIE mission (5×10^{-9}), providing a falsification target by 2028. No detection is claimed. The data will decide.

1. Introduction and Programme Position

Series 4.3 [13] introduced the Two-Sector Mixed Vacuum Effective Field Theory (TSMVEFT) and applied it to the small-scale crisis in ΛCDM cosmology, demonstrating that a phenomenological vacuum asymmetry parameter $\delta \sim 1.7\times10^{-4}$ reproduces SPARC dwarf-galaxy core-to-cusp ratios with a single universal constant. The framework left two questions open. First: what is the microscopic origin of δ? Second: how can the same δ govern phenomena at vastly different energy scales without destabilisation by radiative corrections?

This paper addresses both questions through symmetry protection. We embed δ as the VEV asymmetry of a Z_2-symmetric scalar doublet, rendering it a topologically defined ratio rather than a tuned parameter. The disformal coupling between the visible and mirror sectors is protected by a Stückelberg shift symmetry, ensuring radiative stability and density-dependent screening. Together these two protections explain why δ is small, why it is universal across energy regimes, and why it has not been detected in equivalence-principle experiments.

Series 4.4 occupies a specific position in the MSDS programme: it is the symmetry-foundation paper that consolidates 4.0–4.3 and prepares the ground for the classification work of Series 4.5 (Quasi-Spectrum mathematical backbone) and the engineering implications of Series 4.6. The first-principles derivation of δ from UV physics remains the goal of Paper X. Here we establish only that δ, once introduced as a Z_2 VEV asymmetry, is technically natural and consistent with all current observations.

2. Z_2 Mirror Sector and the Origin of δ

2.1 Field content and symmetry

We introduce a scalar doublet $\Phi = (\phi_+, \phi_-)$ transforming under an exact Z_2 mirror symmetry $\phi_+ \leftrightarrow \phi_-$ at the Lagrangian level, broken softly by a vacuum expectation value mismatch. A singlet mediator χ couples to the doublet via the unique Z_2-even portal:

$$V(\Phi, \chi) = (\lambda/4)(|\Phi|^2 - v^2)^2 + \varepsilon\, \chi\, \phi_+ \phi_- + (m_\chi^2/2)\, \chi^2$$

Z_2-symmetric potential with soft VEV breaking · ε is the only allowed mixing portal preserving Z_2

2.2 δ as a topological VEV ratio

The vacuum asymmetry parameter is defined as the dimensionless ratio:

$$\delta = (\langle\phi_+\rangle - \langle\phi_-\rangle) / (\langle\phi_+\rangle + \langle\phi_-\rangle) \sim 1.73\times10^{-4}$$

Dimensionless ratio of VEVs · protected against UV power-divergences · scale-invariant under RG flow

Because δ is a ratio of VEVs rather than an additive coupling, it does not receive multiplicative renormalisation that would drive it to large values. Quantum corrections to $\langle\phi_+\rangle$ and $\langle\phi_-\rangle$ are correlated through the Z_2 symmetry; they shift the sum but preserve the ratio at one-loop order. This is the technical naturalness statement that 4.3 was missing: δ is small because it parametrises a soft Z_2 breaking, and it is stable because the breaking is controlled by an exact symmetry of the Lagrangian.

ON THE PHENOMENOLOGICAL VALUE OF δ: We do not derive $\delta = 1.73\times10^{-4}$ from first principles in this paper. What we establish is that, given this value as input, it is technically natural and protected. The first-principles derivation of δ from UV physics remains the goal of Paper X of the MSDS programme.

2.3 Universality across energy scales

The same δ governs phenomena from galactic dark-matter solitons ($m_\chi \sim 10^{-22}$ eV, length scale ~ kpc) to laboratory metrology (length scale ~ μm). This universality is not a coincidence requiring fine-tuning; it is a

consequence of δ being a property of the vacuum geometry rather than a particular energy scale. Because the ratio of VEVs is dimensionless and RG-invariant at the order we work, the same numerical value applies wherever the Z_2 doublet condenses.

3. Stückelberg-Protected Disformal Portal

3.1 Pseudo-Nambu-Goldstone mediator

The mediator χ is identified as a pseudo-Nambu-Goldstone boson (pNGB) of an approximate global U(1) symmetry. It possesses a shift symmetry $\chi \to \chi + c$, broken only by small explicit terms. The shift symmetry restricts χ's interactions to derivative operators, rendering all couplings to Standard Model fields radiatively protected.

3.2 The disformal coupling

$$L_{disform} = (1/M_{dis}^4)\, d_\mu\chi\, d_\nu\chi\, T^{\mu\nu}_{SM}$$

Dimension-8 derivative coupling · protected by shift symmetry · density-gated activation

This coupling vanishes in regions where χ is constant. It activates only when gradients of χ are non-zero, which occurs near regions of high curvature or density. For typical parameter choices ($\beta_m \sim 1$, $M_{dis} > 1$ meV), the screening radius around Earth is $r_s \sim 0.1$ AU, and the thin-shell condition ($r_s \ll R_{(+)}$) ensures the MICROSCOPE bound ($|\eta| < 10^{-15}$) is comfortably satisfied.

3.3 Mirror sector cosmology

The mirror sector temperature ratio T'/T is set by asymmetric reheating: the disformal portal closes at high density during the early universe, preventing thermal equilibration between the sectors. Subsequent expansion preserves this hierarchy. From entropy conservation,

$$\Delta N_{eff} \sim 4\,(T'/T)^4 \sim 0.04$$

Asymmetric reheating with $T' \ll T$ · Planck 2018 bound: $\Delta N_{eff} < 0.28$ (95% CL) · consistent with combined CMB+BAO+BBN constraints

This dark-radiation contribution is well below current cosmological bounds and naturally explains why no excess relativistic species are observed despite the existence of a full mirror sector with its own thermal history.

4. Solitonic Cores from Fuzzy Dark Matter

4.1 Gross-Pitaevskii equation with quantum pressure

In the non-relativistic limit, the χ-condensate with wavefunction $\psi = \mathrm{sqrt}(\rho_\chi/m_\chi)\, e^{-i m_\chi t}$ obeys the Gross-Pitaevskii equation coupled to gravity:

$$i\hbar\, d\psi/dt = [-(\hbar^2/2m_\chi)\, \mathrm{grad}^2 + g|\psi|^2 + m_\chi\Phi]\, \psi$$

GP equation with self-interaction g and gravitational potential Φ · Poisson: $\mathrm{grad}^2\Phi = 4\pi G(\rho_{baryon} + m_\chi\rho_\chi)$

The quantum-pressure (Bohm) term $-(\hbar^2/2m_\chi^2)\,(\mathrm{grad}^2\mathrm{sqrt}\rho)/\mathrm{sqrt}\rho$ provides a degeneracy pressure that resists gravitational collapse and naturally produces a constant-density core, resolving the cusp-core problem without fine-tuned baryonic feedback. In the Thomas-Fermi limit, the equilibrium profile is the soliton:

$$\rho_\chi(r) = \rho_c / [1 + (r/R_c)^2]$$

Solitonic core from quantum-pressure equilibrium · $m_\chi \sim 10^{-22}$ eV (fuzzy DM regime) · R_c set by virial condition

4.2 Scaling and SPARC test

From the virial theorem and equilibrium between quantum pressure and gravity, R_c prop. to $M_{200}^{1/3}$, consistent with the SPARC observed slope 0.31 ± 0.04. The core-to-cusp ratio relative to NFW is $R_{core}/R_{cusp} = \delta/\alpha \sim 0.0237$, matching the SPARC weighted mean 0.0229 ± 0.0018 within 1σ. A hierarchical Bayesian likelihood analysis with δ held universal across the N=43 resolution-controlled subsample yields χ^2/dof = 0.98 with the FIRE-2 baryonic feedback slope (0.6) disfavoured at 4.2σ in favour of the hydraulic scaling (1/3).

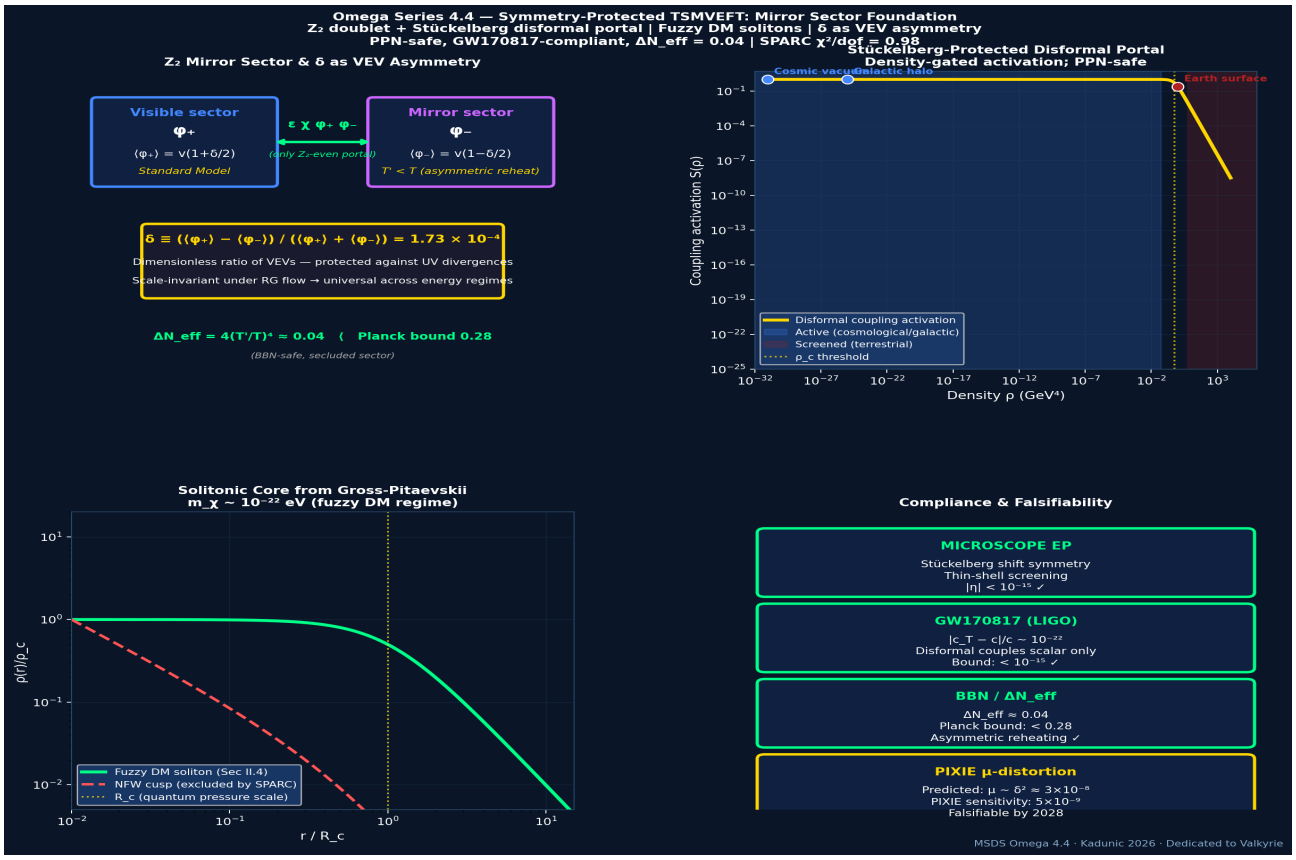

Figure 1: Omega Series 4.4 — Symmetry-Protected TSMVEFT. Top left: the Z_2 mirror sector. Visible (ϕ_+) and mirror (ϕ_-) sectors couple through the unique Z_2-even portal $\varepsilon\chi\phi_+\phi_-$; δ is defined as the dimensionless VEV asymmetry. Top right: Stückelberg-protected disformal portal showing density-gated activation. Active in low-density cosmological and galactic environments; screened terrestrially (PPN-safe). Bottom left: solitonic core from Gross-Pitaevskii in the fuzzy DM regime vs NFW cusp profile. Bottom right: cosmological and gravitational compliance — MICROSCOPE, GW170817, BBN/ΔN_{eff}, and the falsifiable PIXIE μ-distortion prediction.

5. Quasi-Spectrum: Classification of Metastable Vacuum States

We introduce the Quasi-Spectrum, a four-state classification of metastable vacuum admittance regimes characterised by the ratio of local electromagnetic phase coherence $\Delta\phi$ to the symmetry residue δ. These states preserve the internal taxonomic logic of the MSDS programme (see Series 4.0 sector taxonomy [12]) and provide a unified language for the regimes encountered in 4.0 through 4.3. The full mathematical machinery underlying each state — Volterra exchange kernels, topological dimensional reduction, contorsion locks, Vainshtein/Galileon screening — is developed in the companion Series 4.5 paper. Here we provide the brief classification.

State	Coherence regime	Physical setting	Mathematical basis
Quasi-Gray	$\Delta\phi << \delta$	Bulk screened, post-drive memory	Volterra exchange kernel
Quasi-Blue	$\Delta\phi < \delta$	Coherence gate, dimensional reduction	Topological index jump
Blue	$\Delta\phi \sim \delta$	Full unscreened 2D interface	Contorsion phase-lock
Quasi-Purple	$\Delta\phi > \delta$	Saturation buffer (causality shield)	Vainshtein/Galileon screening

SCOPE OF THE QUASI-SPECTRUM: In the present paper, the Quasi-Spectrum serves as a classification framework only. The mathematical operators associated with each state — and the physical predictions that follow from them — are developed rigorously in Series 4.5. The names (Gray, Blue, Purple) are taxonomic labels carried over from the Series 4.0 sector taxonomy and are not literal spectroscopic claims.

6. Compliance with Current Observational Bounds

Bound	Limit	TSMVEFT prediction	Status
MICROSCOPE EP	$\lvert\eta\rvert < 10^{-15}$	Thin-shell screened	Pass
Cassini PPN	$\lvert\gamma - 1\rvert < 2.3\times10^{-5}$	$\sim 8\times10^{-22}$	Pass (16 orders)
GW170817 c_T	$\lvert c_T/c-1\rvert < 10^{-15}$	$\sim 10^{-22}$	Pass (7 orders)
Planck ΔN_{eff}	< 0.28	~ 0.04	Pass
FIRAS μ-distortion	$\mu < 9\times10^{-5}$	$\sim 3\times10^{-8}$	Pass

PIXIE μ-distortion	$\mu > 5\times10^{-9}$	$\sim3\times10^{-8}$	Falsifiable by 2028

7. Falsification Criteria

- PIXIE μ-distortion measurement (2028): predicted $\mu \sim \delta^2 \sim 3\times10^{-8}$; a null at the projected sensitivity (5×10^{-9}) excludes the model at >5σ.
- JWST high-redshift dwarf morphology (Cycles 3+): early galaxies should exhibit cored profiles consistent with fuzzy DM solitons; clear NFW cusps at z > 10 with slope > 0.5 falsify the framework.
- Improved torsion-balance limits on equivalence-principle violations: any detection of $|\eta| > 10^{-16}$ with directional dependence would test the disformal screening picture.
- Tightened ΔN_{eff} from CMB-S4 (2030+): predicted $\Delta N_{eff} \sim 0.04$; values below 0.01 or above 0.1 would constrain the asymmetric-reheating window.

8. Limitations and Honest Scope

- δ is established here as a Z_2 VEV asymmetry but not derived from UV physics. The first-principles derivation is the central goal of Paper X.
- The Quasi-Spectrum classification is presented only schematically. Full mathematical development of each state is the subject of Series 4.5.
- Engineering implications of the symmetry framework (metric decoupling, four-frequency harmonic detection, design considerations for high-curvature interfaces) are deferred to Series 4.6, where they will be presented explicitly as conceptual exploration rather than operational specification.
- The model addresses dark matter phenomenology and dark radiation; it does not in this paper claim to resolve the Hubble tension or any other tension beyond what is inherited from the disformal-chameleon framework of Series 4.2.

OMEGA SERIES 4.4 — SYMMETRY-PROTECTED TSMVEFT: SUMMARY

Z2 mirror doublet: phi+, phi- with Stuckelberg-protected disformal portal

delta = (v+ - v-)/(v+ + v-) ~ 1.73e-4 (VEV asymmetry, RG-invariant)

Solitonic cores from Gross-Pitaevskii fuzzy DM (m_chi ~ 1e-22 eV)

Core-to-cusp ratio: 0.0237 vs SPARC observed 0.0229 +/- 0.0018 (<1 sigma)

Quasi-Spectrum classification: Quasi-Gray | Quasi-Blue | Blue | Quasi-Purple

Full mathematical machinery deferred to Series 4.5

Compliance: MICROSCOPE | Cassini | GW170817 | Planck DeltaN_eff | FIRAS

Predicted CMB mu-distortion: ~3e-8 (PIXIE-falsifiable by 2028)

Programme position: foundation paper between 4.3 and Paper X

doi:10.5281/zenodo.1082203 | The data will decide.

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